

International Collaboration in Animal Behavior:

An analysis of coauthorship in three leading journals

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Methods

On June 12, 2025 we downloaded the bibliographic record of every article published in *Animal Behavior*, *Behavioral Ecology*, and *Behavioral Ecology & Sociobiology* that was indexed in the Web of Science *Core Collection*. These records were then processed and organized using the R package **refsplitr**, with which we also disambiguated author names and visualized author locations and coauthorship networks.

Countries were assigned to Global Regions and National Income Categories using the World Bank categories. Data and Code are available on Github.

Fournier, A., M. E. Boone, F. R. Stevens, and E. M. Bruna. 2020. **refsplitr**: Author name disambiguation, author georeferencing, and mapping of coauthorship networks with Web of Science data. *Journal of Open Source Software*, 5(45), 2028, <https://doi.org/10.21105/joss.02028>

Results

Publications

1. No. of Publications (*all journals combined*): N = 23,794
2. No. of Publications with at least 1 author from LatAm (*all journals combined*): N = 874 (3.7%)
3. No. of Publications with 1st author from LatAm (*all journals combined*): N = 565 (2.4%)

Journal	N	n_latam_first	percent_latam
animal behaviour	12,471	249	2.0
behavioral ecology	4,836	98	2.0
behavioral ecology and sociobiology	6,487	233	3.6

4. Publications per Journal (overall and with LatAm 1st Author)

Authors

1. Total No. of Authors (*all journals combined*): N = 27,749
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2. In which countries are authors based? Top N = 20 countries (*all journals combined*)

Country (ISO code)	N	percent
usa (usa)	20,591	29.87
uk (gbr)	6,294	9.13
canada (can)	5,267	7.64
germany (deu)	4,207	6.10
australia (aus)	4,133	6.00
united kingdom (gbr)	3,422	4.96
france (fra)	2,998	4.35
spain (esp)	2,010	2.92
sweden (swe)	1,742	2.53
netherlands (nld)	1,585	2.30
switzerland (che)	1,579	2.29
italy (ita)	1,464	2.12
japan (jpn)	1,118	1.62
finland (fin)	1,101	1.60
china (chn)	1,058	1.53
norway (nor)	941	1.37
south africa (zaf)	744	1.08
israel (isr)	703	1.02
brazil (bra)	686	1.00
belgium (bel)	676	0.98

region	N	percent
europa & central asia	31,477	45.67
north america	25,858	37.51
east asia & pacific	7,301	10.59
latin america & caribbean	2,133	3.09
sub-saharan africa	1,114	1.62
middle east & north africa	739	1.07
south asia	308	0.45

3. In which region are authors based?

4. What are the most commonly represented affiliations? Top N = 20 Affiliations (*all journals combined*)

Preliminary Results: affiliations still require some cleaning

Note: these are not unique authors (i.e., the same author at UF publishing 5 papers = UF x 5)

Affiliation	Country	N
university of oxford	united kingdom	270
university of cambridge	united kingdom	242
university of california, davis	usa	219
university of bristol	united kingdom	179
cornell university	usa	161
university of toronto	canada	137
university of washington	usa	135
university of st andrews	united kingdom	133
cnsr centre national de la recherche scientifique	france	124
max-planck-institut für ornithologie	germany	121
lunds universitet	sweden	118
rijksuniversiteit groningen	netherlands	118
indiana university bloomington	usa	113
the university of edinburgh	united kingdom	109
queen's university	canada	105
university of california, berkeley	usa	105
stockholms universitet	sweden	103
universität zürich	switzerland	100
university of wisconsin-madison	usa	97
the university of sheffield	united kingdom	95

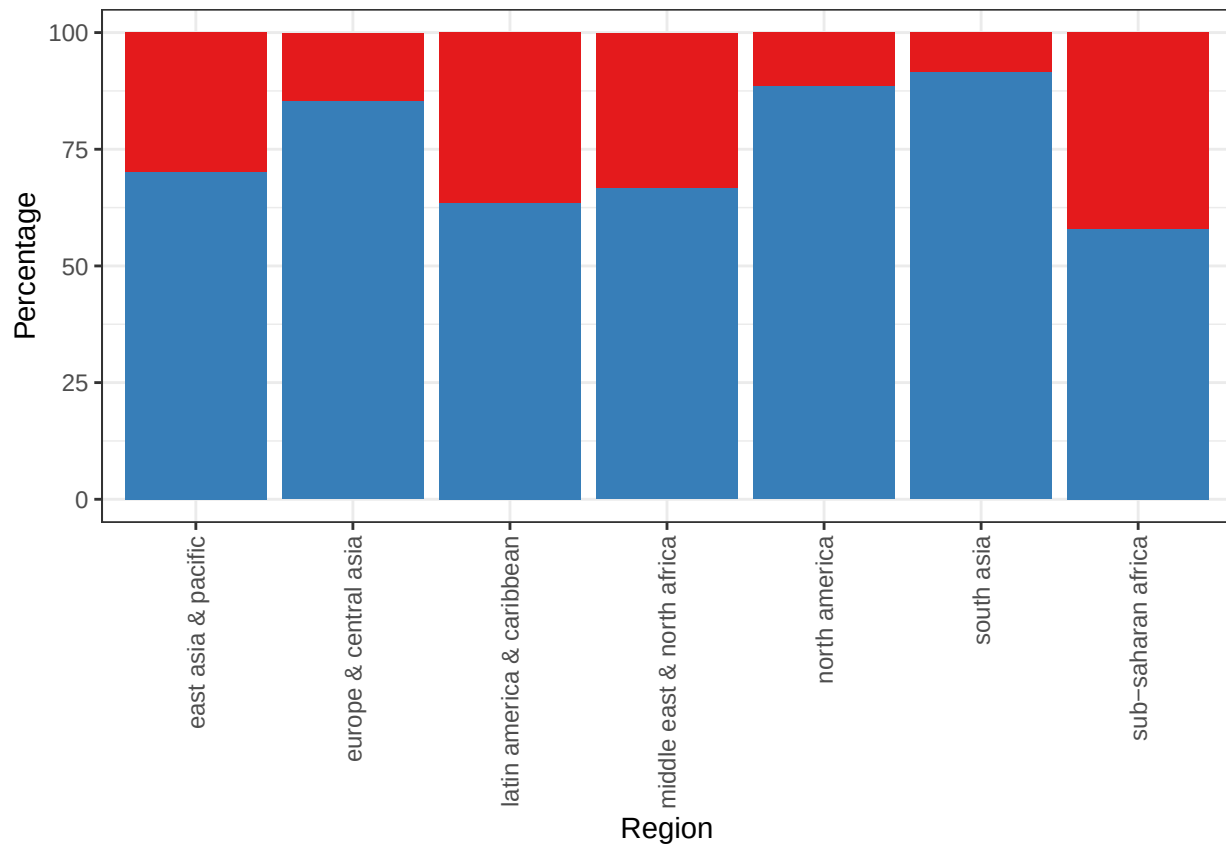
region	avg_n_authors	sd_n_authors	avg_n_countries	sd_n_countries
east asia & pacific	3.7	1.7	1.4	0.65
europa & central asia	3.6	1.8	1.4	0.69
latin america & caribbean	3.7	1.7	1.5	0.71
middle east & north africa	3.7	2.2	1.5	0.88
north america	3.1	1.5	1.2	0.47
south asia	3.1	1.3	1.1	0.31
sub-saharan africa	3.4	1.4	1.5	0.61

4. No. of coauthors & No. of countries on author list by region of 1st author

Coauthorhsip Analysis (*Note: Only papers with >1 author*)

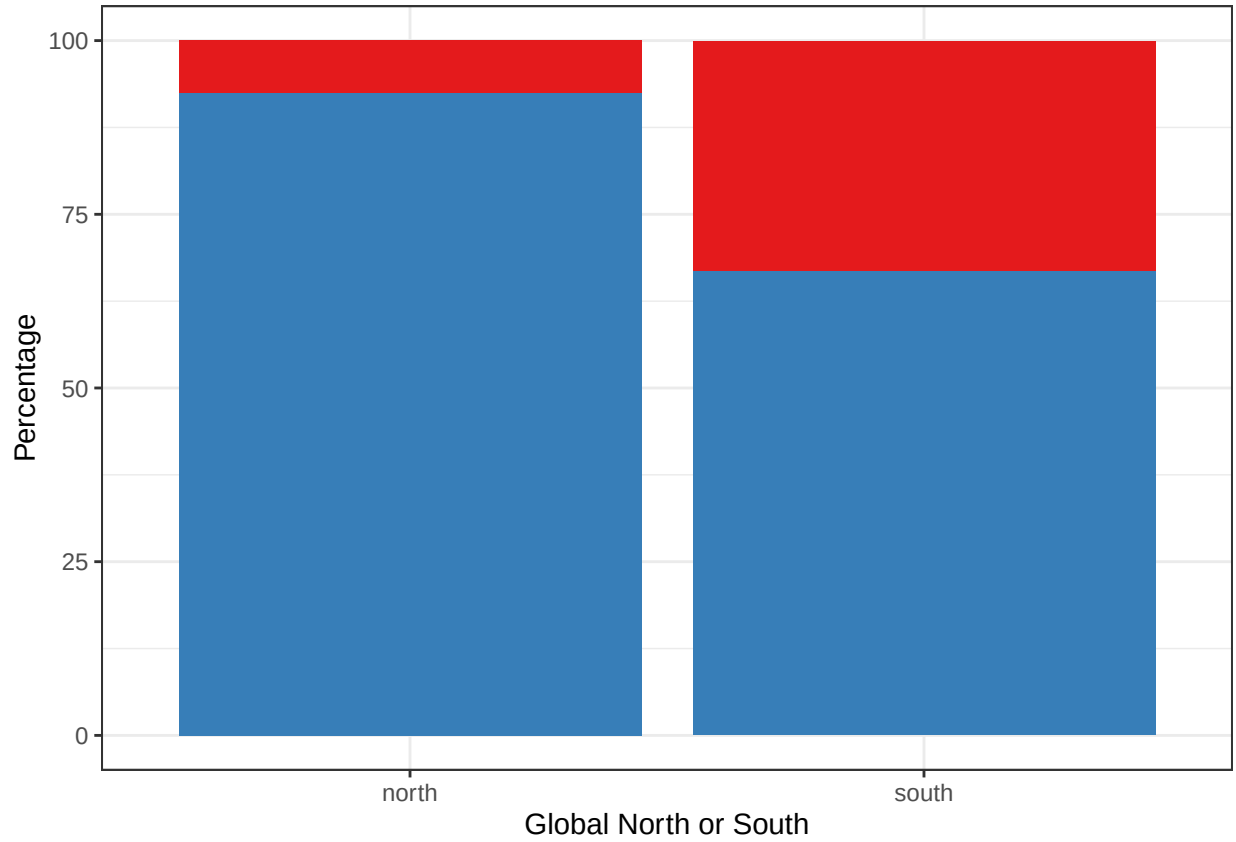
first author based in...	all coauthors in same region	N	%
east asia & pacific	TRUE	1419	70.18
east asia & pacific	FALSE	603	29.82
europa & central asia	TRUE	7396	85.46
europa & central asia	FALSE	1258	14.54
latin america & caribbean	TRUE	340	63.43
latin america & caribbean	FALSE	196	36.57
middle east & north africa	TRUE	145	66.82
middle east & north africa	FALSE	72	33.18
north america	TRUE	6833	88.49
north america	FALSE	889	11.51
south asia	TRUE	86	91.49
south asia	FALSE	8	8.51
sub-saharan africa	TRUE	121	57.89
sub-saharan africa	FALSE	88	42.11

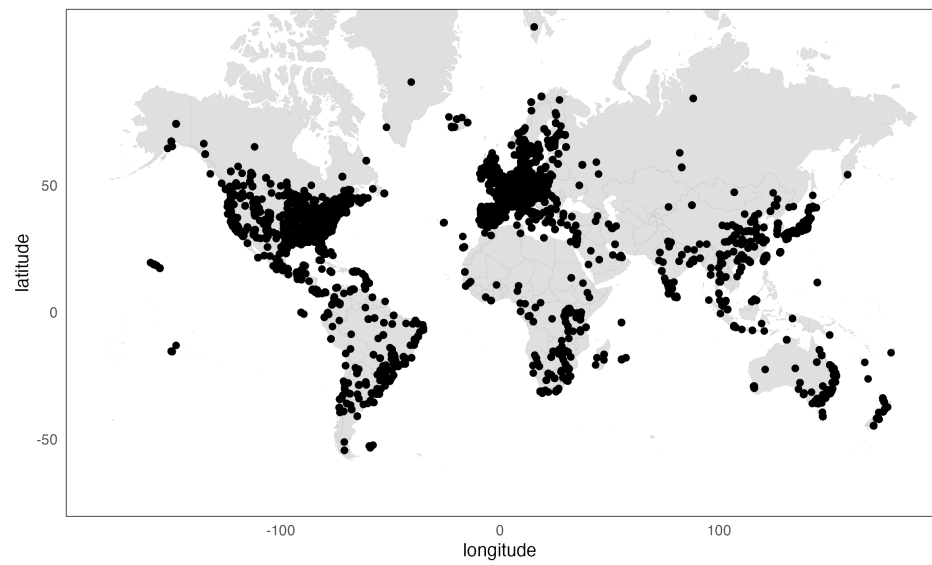
1. Are all co-authors from the same global region as the 1st Author?



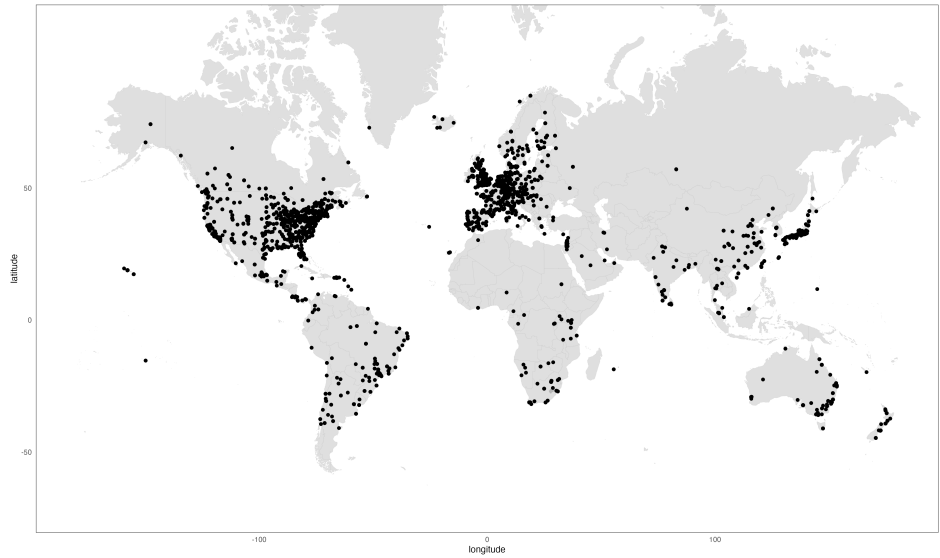
first author based in...	all coauthors in same	N	%
north	FALSE	1393	7.58
north	TRUE	16980	92.42
south	FALSE	426	33.23
south	TRUE	856	66.77

2. Where are the coauthors of papers with 1st authors based in the Global North or South?





All author locations



1st Author Locations

1st Authors based in Latin America & Caribbean

1st Authors based in the USA

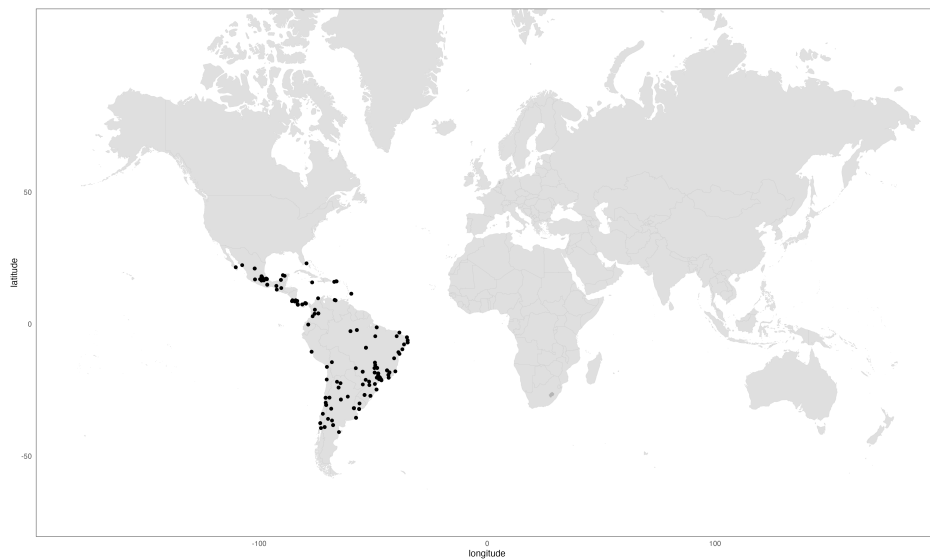


Figure 1: Locations of 1st authors based in Latin America

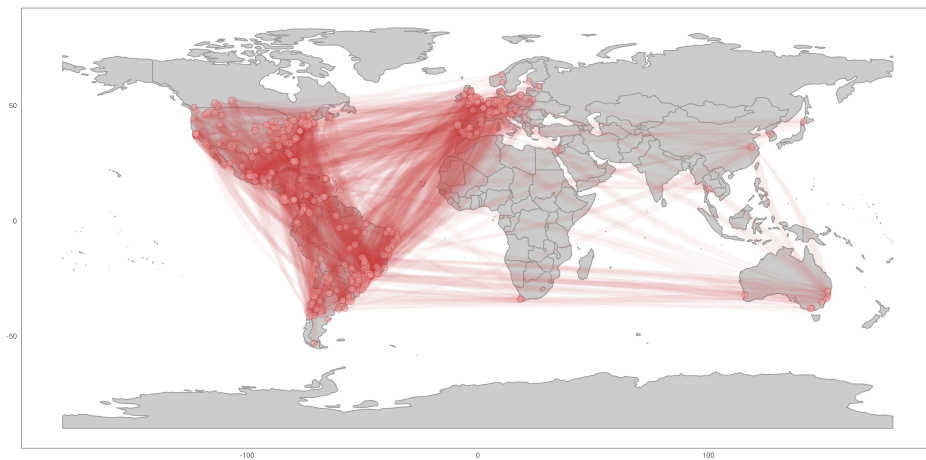


Figure 2: Coauthorship Networks for articles with 1st authors based in Latin America

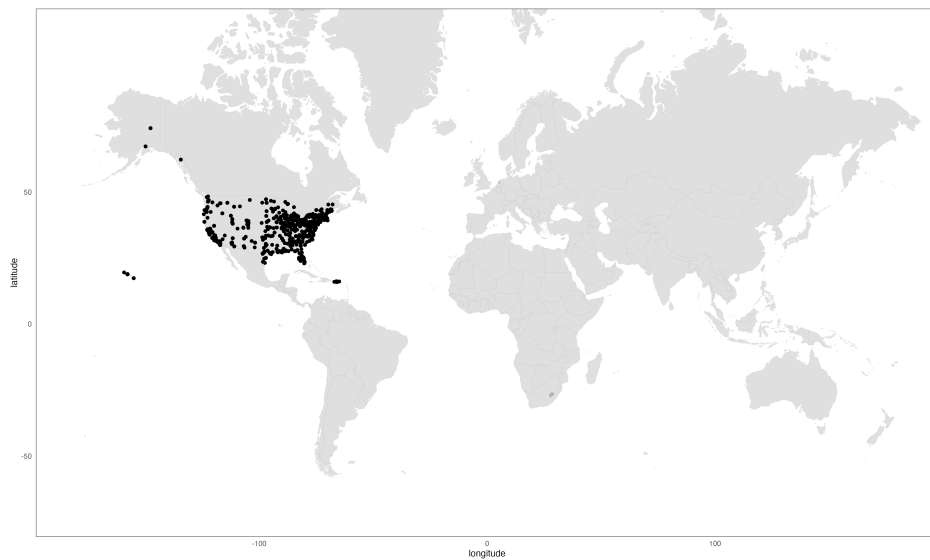


Figure 3: Locations of 1st authors based in USA

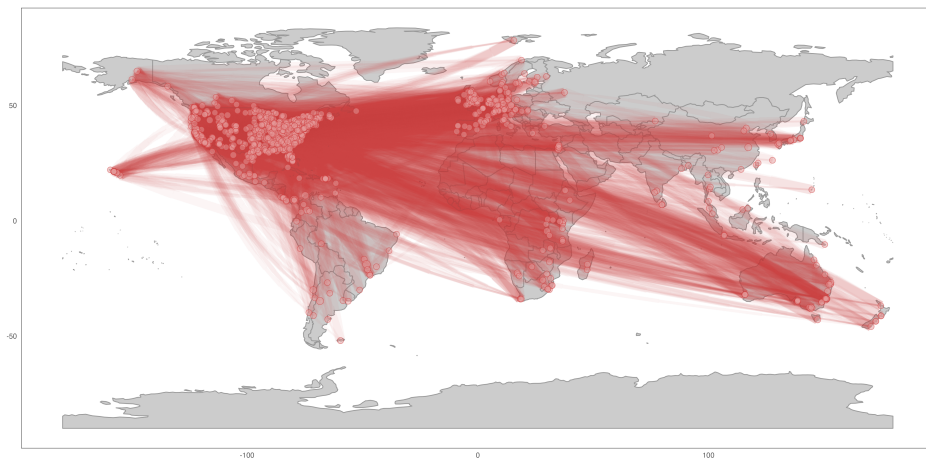


Figure 4: Coauthorship Networks for articles with 1st authors based in USA